MIL-D-36572A
18 August 1975
SUPERSEDING
MIL-D-36572
18 December 1968

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

DESK, FLAT TOP

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a folding type nurse's desk designed for use in military field hospitals. When folded for shipment, the desk shall be capable of being used for storage of medical records and forms, and provide a shipping space for the nurse's folding desk chair.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

QQ-A-200/9	Aluminum Alloy Bar, Rod, Shapes, Tube, and Wire, Extruded, 6063.
QQ-A-225/6	Aluminum Alloy Bar, Rod, and Wire, Rolled, Drawn, or Cold Finished, 2024.
QQ-A-250/8	Aluminum Alloy, 5052, Plate and Sheet.
QQ-A-250/11	Aluminum Alloy, 6061, Plate and Sheet.
TT-E-491	Enamel, Gloss, Synethetic, for Metal and Wood Hospital Furniture.
TT-P-1757	Primer Coating, Zinc Chromate, Low-Moisture Sensitivity.
PPP-B-601	Boxes, Wood, Cleated Plywood.
PPP-B-640	Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.

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Military

MIL-C-5541	Chemicals, Films and Chemical Film Materials for Aluminum and Aluminum Alloys.

STANDARDS

Federal

FED-STD-66	Steel, Chemical Composition and Hardenability.
FED-STD-151	Metal, Test Methods.
FED-STD-595	Colors.

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

DRAWING

Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC)

24143	Desk, Folding, Nurses, Field.

(Copies of specifications, standards, and drawings required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Except as hereinafter specified, materials shall conform to the applicable portions of the specifications, standards and drawings listed herein. When materials to be used are not specifically designated, they shall be suitable for the purpose intended. Materials shall be subjected to the tests and meet the requirements specified in these documents. Metals shall conform to the chemical and physical requirements of the applicable specifications.

3.1.1 Aluminum sheet. All aluminum sheet shall be alloy 5052, temper H34 conforming to QQ-A-250/8 except for the leg gussets. Aluminum sheet for leg gussets shall be alloy 6061, temper T4 conforming to QQ-A-250/11.

3.1.2 Aluminum rectangular tubing. Aluminum rectangular tubing shall be alloy 6063, temper T5 conforming to QQ-A-200/9.

3.1.3 Aluminum square & rectangular bars. Aluminum square and rectangular bars shall be alloy 2024, temper T4 conforming to QQ-A-225/6.

* 3.1.4 Steel sheet. Steel sheet where specified shall be corrosion-resisting steel conforming to FED-STD-66, AISI 300 series, when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

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3.2 Design and construction. The design and construction of the desk shall conform to the requirements specified herein, DPSC Drawing 24143 and the Bill of Materials thereto. The desk shall consist of a left pedestal, center section, and right pedestal, the top of each forming the completed desk top when in an unfolded upright position. Two continuous hinges shall attach the pedestals to the center section, allowing the folding of the pedestals toward each other when two lock bars are released. The desk shall be locked in the folded position with a spring-loaded and hinged bar. Overall dimensions of the desk shall not exceed 59 inches wide by 22 inches deep by 30 inches high when open, and 31 inches wide by 22 inches deep by 17 inches high when closed. The legs and pedestals shall be joined together, both by machine screws and tack-welding, thus forming a rigid unit. Prior to welding, the desk top and pedestal components shall be aligned and secured to assure a rigid and level assembly. The weight of the desk shall not exceed 70 pounds. In its closed configuration, the desk shall provide space to accommodate the folding chair described in 6.1. The chair is not a component of the desk. Commercial tolerances shall apply to all material gages specified herein.

3.2.1 Pedestal. The left pedestal shall contain one large drawer and form a housing for same. The housing shall be constructed of 0.081 inch thick No. 12 Birmingham and Stubs gage (No. 12 B & S gage) aluminum sheet. The pedestal legs shall be 1 inch by 2 inches by 0.095 inch No. 13 Birmingham and Stubs gage aluminum tubing reinforced with two 0.091 inch thick (No. 11 B & S gage) aluminum gussets at both 90° junctions of the legs. There shall be a sheet steel slide inside the pedestal and on the bottom to mate with the drawer slide. The pedestal slide shall be 0.050 inch thick (No. 18 U.S.S. Revised gage) sheet.

* 3.2.1.1 Drawer. Drawer sides and bottom shall be fabricated from one continuous sheet of 0.081 inch thick aluminum No. 12 B & S gage. The drawer back shall be panshaped with all flanges extending back. All flanged parts shall be spotwelded to the bottom and sides. All four corners of the front panel shall be mitered, flanged, formed, and welded. Each welded corner shall be ground smooth on the outside. The back of the drawer and the front panel shall be formed of 0.081 inch thick No. 12 B & S gage aluminum sheet. There shall be a hole with a convex dust cover of 0.032 inch thick (No. 20 B & S gage) aluminum sheet spotwelded to the inside or back of front panel in lieu of a handle for opening of drawers. The hole shall be of sufficient circumference to facilitate finger grip. Two adjustable dividers of 0.040 inch thick No. 18 B & S gage aluminum sheet shall be included in the large left drawer which shall have grooves to accommodate the dividers.

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* 3.2.1.2 Drawer slide. The drawer slide shall have a sheet steel slide attached to its bottom side with slotted flat head machine screws. A small formed steel angle, spotwelded to the drawer slide at one end, shall act as a drawer stop to prevent inadvertent removal of the drawer. There shall be tongue and grooved type of mating between the pedestal and drawer slides with clearances such that the drawer will operate smoothly. The drawer slide and angle shall both be 0.050 inch thick No. 18 U.S. Standard gage sheet (U.S.S.).

3.2.2 Center section. The center section shall consist of a top panel and act as the principal supporting member of the desk. The top of this section and the two pedestal tops shall be of one-piece construction with all corner joints welded, ground and polished smooth. Included with the center section shall be two aluminum spring-loaded lock bars which shall prevent collapse of the right and left pedestals.

3.2.3 Right pedestal. The right pedestal houses two small drawers of equal size which are separated by a 0.081 inch thick No. 12 B & S gage aluminum drawer divider. The bottom drawer shall contain a pencil tray of 0.081 inch thick No. 12 B & S gage aluminum. A 0.064 inch thick No. 14 B & S gage aluminum pencil tray stop shall be attached to the bottom side of the drawer divider. The aluminum lock bar used to lock the desk in the folded position shall be part of the right pedestal. There shall be a sheet steel slide inside the pedestal and on the bottom to mate with the bottom drawer slide. Another slide shall be attached to the top side of the drawer divider to mate with the top drawer slide. Manner of construction and materials shall be as specified for the left pedestal and its components. This includes the pedestal housing, legs and gussets, pedestal slides, drawers and dust covers, drawer slides and drawer stop angles.

* 3.3 Finish. All surfaces of the desk, including drawers, shall be thoroughly cleaned and chemically degreased. The parts, excluding those of corrosion-resisting steel, then shall be given a chemical film conforming to MIL-C-5541. Except for corrosion-resisting steel surfaces, the top surface of the desk and side flanges of the top surface, all other surfaces shall be given a coat of zinc chromate primer in accordance with TT-P-1757 followed by two coats of synthetic gloss enamel, Class B of TT-E-491. Color shall be 14241 of FED-STD-595 (see 6.4). Each coat shall be sprayed on and baked in high temperature ovens in accordance with the paint manufacturer's recommendations. In order to preclude marring and scoring, the top surfaces and the side flanges shall be given a special primer coat, followed by a 2-1/2 mil finish coat (see 6.3).

* 3.4 Identification marking. Each desk shall be permanently and legibly marked with the contract number on the front turned-down flange of the center section top.

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3.5 *Service data.* The contractor shall enclose, with each unit, two copies each, of one or more service data booklets. In addition, the contractor shall mail 15 copies of the approved service data to the contracting officer for distribution. The service data shall contain complete instructions for installation, operation, maintenance, and a list of component parts. Each part of the unit other than common fasteners shall be identified in the service data and parts list by the manufacturer's part number. As soon as practicable after award of the contract or purchase order, the contractor shall furnish to the contracting officer, via the cognizant Government inspector, two preliminary copies of his proposed service data, for review and comment by Directorate of Medical Materiel, Defense Personnel Support Center. The preliminary service data shall be submitted sufficiently early to permit adequate review by the Directorate of Medical Materiel, Defense Personnel Support Center (based on a maximum period of 30 days for such review) and to allow incorporation by the contractor of required revisions and corrections in the final service data without delaying delivery under the contract or purchase order. Should the supplier have furnished acceptable manuals for the identical item within two years preceding the date of contract, and propose to furnish manuals identical with those previously accepted, the requirements for review of drafts and submission of 15 additional copies may be waived upon request.

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The desk shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or which may impair its serviceability. All exposed corners and edges shall be broken, rounded, or otherwise treated to eliminate sharp edges.

3.6.1 Welding. Welding shall be durable, sound in every detail and in accordance with latest practices recommended by the American Welding Society. All welds shall be produced by qualified welding operators with satisfactory welding equipment using satisfactory filler metal and/or electrode where applicable to provide the best possible weld. Surfaces to be welded shall be free from grease, oil, oxides or any other foreign matter. Any cleaning method which will remove these substances and leave the surface clean is satisfactory. All aluminum parts shall be welded within 48 hours after a chemical cleaning treatment. Parts must be chemically recleaned if the 48 hour time period is exceeded. All weld joints shall blend into the adjacent metal in gradual, smooth curves. Beads shall be smooth and free of slag, excessive undercut, or excessive spatter. Sufficient metal shall be added to provide a suitable fillet or reinforcement unless otherwise specified. Fusion through the full thickness of the base metal, in areas other than those where 100 percent penetration is a requirement of joint design, is not acceptable when welding materials over 0.050 inch in thickness. Welds shall not be oxidized. All welds shall be continuous with no visible voids, pin holes or cracks which affect the quality, and have more strength than required for purpose intended.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to insure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties).

* 4.1.2 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. When available, certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the component or material, listing the specified test method and test results obtained, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor.

4.2 Sampling. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and Table I.

Table I. Sampling for examination

	Inspection level	AQL (defects per hundred units)
For visual examination		
Major defects	II	1.0
Total (major and minor combined)	II	4.0

4.2.1 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with inspection level S-4 of MIL-STD-105. The acceptance level shall be zero.

4.3 Examination. The desk shall be examined to determine compliance with all the requirements contained in this specification.

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4.3.1 Classification of defects. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with the following classification of defects:

Table II. Classification of defects

Categories	* Defects
Major	
101	Any component part missing, broken, or otherwise unusable.
102	Exposed edges not free of burs and sharpness.
103	Components not properly assembled or aligned.
104	Desk not readily opened and closed.
105	Drawers not smoothly movable on slides.
106	Lock bars not securely locking desk in open and closed positions.
Minor	
201	Identification marking not complete, permanent and legible.
202	Identification marking not securely attached to unit.
203	Finish not free of chipped areas, cracks, scratches, and roughness.
204	Desk does not rest evenly on a flat surface.
205	Color not as specified.
206	Service data not furnished as specified.

* Examination shall not be restricted to the classified possible defects listed above.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Chemical composition. Tests for chemical analysis shall be conducted in accordance with method 111.2 or 112.2 of FED-STD-151.

* 4.5 Examination for preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of Section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in Table III. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2, and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

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* Table III. Examination for preparation for delivery

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Quantity	Quantity in interior packages and shipping containers not as specified.
Packaging and packing materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, tape improperly applied, or containers distorted.
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

* 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit package. Each desk shall be folded and secured to prevent accidental opening. The desk shall be cushioned with flexible corrugated fiberboard or other suitable material to insure against marring, scratching, or damage to the unit. Cushioning material shall be secured with tape. Each desk shall be further packed in a box designed for a type 3 load constructed in accordance with PPP-B-601, overseas type, or PPP-B-640, style E, class 2. All box panels of PPP-B-601 shall be lined with a waterproof barrier material. Box conforming to PPP-B-640 shall be waterproof as specified in the appendix of the box specification. Closure and strapping of the boxes shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Steel strapping shall not be used on boxes conforming to PPP-B-601.

5.1.2 Level C. Each desk shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

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5.2 Marking. Each unit package shall be marked as required for the exterior container as specified in MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The desk is intended for use with Chair, Folding, Nurse's Field Desk, NSN 6530-00-115-2992 in military field hospitals.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable levels of packaging (see 5.1).

6.3 Special primer and finish. An acceptable primer coat and finish coat for the top surfaces and side flanges of the desk are manufactured by Minnesota Mining and Manufacturing Company as Nextel Primer No. 901 P2 and Nextel Suede Coating, Color No. 3101-B2. Both products are in conformance with requirements of 3.3.

6.4 Availability of color chips. The individual 3 by 5 inch chips of the color referenced in 3.3 are available from the General Services Administration, Business Service Center, Region 3, Seventh and D Streets S.W., Washington, DC 20704.

6.5 This specification covers the following item listed in the Federal Supply Catalog.

NSN	
6530-00-115-2993	DESK, FLAT TOP, Nurse's Double Pedestal, Corrosion-Resisting Metal, Field

6.6 This specification does not cover all types, classes, grades, or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the type normally procured to meet requirements.

6.7 The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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5. PROBLEM AREAS

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